The metro gets you close.
The last 3 km breaks the day.

India is building metros fast. The first and last kilometre is still a scooter, an auto, or a long walk.

675M
urban Indians by 2035
+133M vs 2025 [1]

263M
two-wheelers, 74% of all vehicles
registered, 2022 [2]

44.8%
of road deaths are two-wheeler riders
1.73 lakh deaths, 2023 [3]

25–35%
of forecast metro ridership reached
last-km gap is a key reason (my view) [4]

Last 2 km today: walk 25 min in the heat, pay ~₹60 a leg by auto, or buy the scooter we are replacing.

WHO WE BUILD FOR

ILLUSTRATIVE

R

Ravi, 29
Sales executive · Hyderabad

2.5 km
home to metro

₹120
a day on autos, both legs

25 min
walk if he skips the auto

"The metro is perfect. It's the first and last 2 km that break my day."

Core user: 1–5 km to a metro, rail or work hub · no car · ₹15–50k a month. Persona and costs are my illustration, not survey data.

THE OPPORTUNITY

A predictable ride for the last 3 km.

THE ANSWER

Ola Loop · a pod every 5 minutes, no booking

Sources [1]–[4] on page 5. Persona and the ₹60 auto fare are my own illustration and estimate.

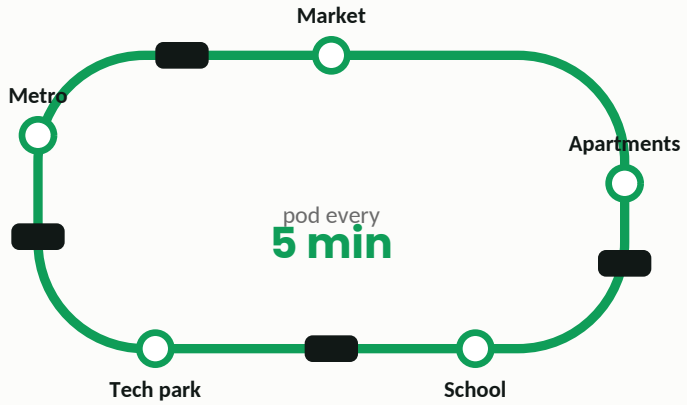
Ola Loop. A lift for the city.

Small electric pods on fixed 6 km loops. A pod every 5 minutes. Tap in, ride, tap out.

HOW IT WORKS

1. **Walk to a Loop stop**
   Stops sit at metro exits, tech parks and neighbourhood hubs.
2. **A pod every 5 minutes**
   No booking, no waiting for a match. Live ETA in the app.
3. **Tap in**
   Ola app QR or a transit card. Flat fare, any distance on the Loop.
4. **Ride 1–4 stops, tap out**
   The pod never detours. Same route all day.

ONE LOOP · ~6 KM · 4 PODS



20 min	12 h	8
circuit	a day	seats

Stops are fixed and numbered, so a rider learns the Loop once and never checks the app again.

PRICE

₹12 a ride, flat

₹499 a month, unlimited

Ravi pays ~₹2,640 a month on autos today (estimate).

NOT BUILDING

- **Booking or seat matching**
- **Surge pricing**
- **Routes that change**
- **Standing room**
- **Anything a rider must plan**

THE DESIGN RULE

Simple beats smart.

No booking. No matching. No surge.

Same loop, same stops, a pod every 5 minutes.

Fares and screens are illustrative (assumptions A2–A4, page 5). Auto fare and Ravi's monthly spend are my estimates.

Fixed loops beat booked rides.

We weighed five ways to play. Only one scales to 100M on cost and road space.

01 · SIX WAYS TO PLAY

Electric micro-car (owned) — REJECTED
49M cars vs 263M two-wheelers. 100M more won't fit. [2]

On-demand shared pods — REJECTED
Matching, detours and empty legs push cost per seat-km up.

E-bikes and e-cycles — REJECTED
Same safety and weather problem. Poor for women.

Electric autos, 1:1 — FEEDER ROLE
3–5× the cost per seat-km (my estimate). Drivers can join Loop.

Large e-bus / BRT — PARTNER
Public-sector turf. Slow dwell at stops. Partner, not rival.

Ola Loop · fixed-route pods — CHOSEN
Lowest cost per seat-km Ola controls. Nothing to match or book.

CELLS	**Own LFP and NMC cells** 46100 LFP BIS-certified · 6 GWh plant [5]
MAPS	**Ola Maps + Krutrim** Designs Loops from demand and holds the 5-min gap [6]
SOFTWARE	**MoveOS + ADAS + AI ops** One stack for pod, fleet and safety [5]

HONEST GAPS

0.8M pods need ~31 GWh of cells vs 6 GWh planned. **Partners fund the rest.** Ola Electric, Maps, Krutrim and Ola Consumer are separate companies (A5).

TRIED BEFORE

Ola Shuttle (2015) ran long bus routes and closed in 2018 after permit clashes [7]. **Our difference:** short fixed loops on permitted stops, launched first on private roads.

THE CHOICE

Fixed loops scale. Booking doesn't.

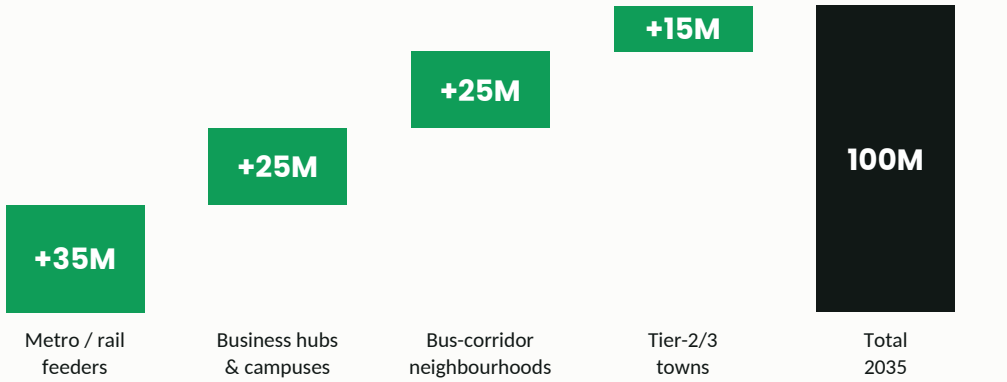
Cells + maps + software, one stack
That is Ola's edge, and the cost floor.

Sources [2], [5]–[7] on page 5. Verdicts and cost multiples are my assessment. Trade-off accepted: a walk to a stop and a shared ride.

100M riders need ~0.8M pods, not 100M vehicles.

Built city by city, one Loop at a time.

01 · WHERE 100M COMES FROM (ILLUSTRATIVE)

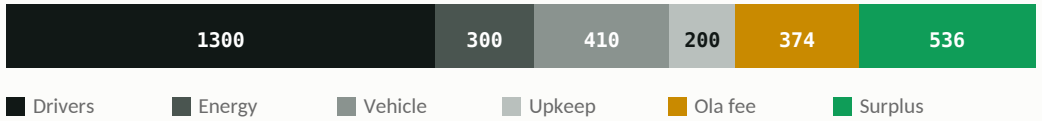


1M	10M	35M	100M
2028 · 2 cities	2030 · 15 cities	2032 · 60 cities	2035 · ~120 cities

02 · WHAT MUST BE TRUE

Density	≥840 rides a day per Loop (break-even)
Price	₹12 a ride, ₹499 a month
Permits	Fixed-route shuttle category in big states by ~2029
Capital	Partners fund pods and ~31 GWh of cells
Trust	Women ≥40% of riders; incidents below taxi benchmark

03 · ONE POD, ONE DAY (₹)



Revenue ₹3,120 = 260 rides × ₹12. Break-even: ~210 rides a day. Surplus ≈ ₹536.

THE RULE

Headway decides everything.

A Loop = 4 pods, 6 km, a pod every 5 min.

~1,040 rides a day per Loop. ~190k Loops at 100M riders.

Illustrative scenario, not a forecast. Unit economics in 2026 rupees (A1–A6, page 5). 100M riders = 200M rides a day. Ola's 12% ≈ ₹29 crore a day.

Success isn't more rides. It's riders who come back.

One North Star. Three proof points. Gates before scale.

NORTH STAR

DAILY ACTIVE COMMUTERS

People who ride Ola Loop on a working day. Same number as the 100M goal.

HABIT

≥70%

90-day retention

RELIABILITY

≥95%

waits of 7 min or less

ECONOMICS

≥₹400

surplus per pod per day

SAFETY Women ≥40% of riders · incidents below taxi benchmark

WHAT COULD BREAK IT → WHAT WE DO

NO RIDERS

Loop under 840 rides a day after 8 weeks

→ Re-route or merge the Loop

NO RHYTHM

Pods bunch, waits above 7 min

→ Ola Maps holds pods at stops

NO SAFETY

Incident rate above benchmark

→ Pause the Loop, don't defend it

NO PERMIT

<3 big states by 2029

→ Campuses, tech parks, gated towns

FIRST 90 DAYS · THREE TESTS

Will they ride unbooked?

3 pilot Loops · ≥840 rides a day by week 8

Will they pay ₹12?

Price ladder: ₹8 / 12 / 16 and ₹499 pass

Can 4 pods hold 5 min?

95% of waits ≤7 min over 8 weeks

Scale only when habit, reliability and economics all hold.

If one breaks → constrain → iterate → retest

ASSUMPTIONS

A1 ~300M city residents commute daily by 2035 (~45% of 675M); 100M riders = ~1 in 3; 2 rides a day. My estimates.
A2 Fare ₹12 a ride; pass ₹499 (44 rides ≈ ₹11.3); auto ≈ ₹60 a leg for 2–3 km; Ravi 22 days × ₹120 = ₹2,640.
A3 Loop 6 km, 4 pods, 20-min circuit, 18 km/h, 12 h/day (216 km); 8 seats, 45% load, 3 km average trip = ~260 rides a pod.
A4 2 driver shifts ₹650 each; energy ₹10/kWh at 0.14 kWh/km; pod ₹7 lakh, 40 kWh LFP, 7 yrs, 10% financing; upkeep ₹200; fee 12%. 2026 rupees.
A5 Ola Electric, Consumer, Maps and Krutrim cooperate commercially; separate companies today.
A6 Large states create a fixed-route shuttle category by ~2029. The 100M build-up (35/25/25/15M) is illustrative.

SOURCES

[1] UN-Habitat World Cities Report 2022 via PTI / Deccan Herald, 30 Jun 2022. deccanherald.com/india/india-s-urban-population-to-stand-at-675-mn-in-2035-behind-china-s-1-bn-un-1122643.html
[2] MoRTH data via Newslaundry, 10 Nov 2025. newslaundry.com/2025/11/10/more-two-wheelers-gig-workersunder-pressure-in-india-9-bike-riders-die-every-hour
[3] MoRTH, Road Accidents in India 2023, via Siasat. siasat.com/1-72-lakh-people-died-in-road-accidents-in-2023-road-ministry-report-3264450/
[4] Indian Infrastructure, 10 Sep 2026 (indianinfrastructure.com/2026/09/10/growing-ridership-key-developments-in-the-urban-transport-sector/); Indrastra, Apr 2026 (indrastra.com/2026/04/indias-metro-networks-ambitious.html).
[5] Ola Electric Q1 FY27 results, 7 Aug 2026, via EMobility+. emobilityplus.com/2026/08/07/ola-electric-reports-inr-455-crore-revenue-in-q1-fy27-as-deliveries-nearly-double-and-market-share-rebounds/
[6] Outlook Business, Jul 2024. outlookbusiness.com/corporate/ola-maps-to-krutrim-ai-a-look-at-the-company-move-to-in-house-platforms
[7] Medianama, 6 Feb 2018. medianama.com/2018/02/223-ola-shuts-bus-service-ola-shuttle/